Bio-bibliography

H 1328

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A. Background

The free-floating form subdivision ***--Bio-bibliography*** is assigned to works that contain both biographical information about authors and lists of books, articles, etc., written by them. This instruction sheet provides guidelines for using the subdivision ***--Bio-bibliography***.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Bio-bibliographies***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

For guidelines on abstracts, see H 1205. For guidelines on bibliographies of individuals, see H 1322. For guidelines on bibliographies of bibliographies, see H 1325. For guidelines on biography, see H 1330. For catalogs of library materials, see H 1361. For guidelines on diaries, see H 1538. For guidelines on digests of legal materials, see H 1550. For guidelines on interviews, see H 1678. For guidelines on personal narratives of wars or disasters, see H 1928. For guidelines on genealogy and family histories, see H 1631.

B. Recent revisions

2026-02: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. Definitions

Bio-bibliography: a bibliography with biographical notes about the authors or authors listed[1]

[1] https://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/biobibliography

D. General

Use the free-floating form subdivision ***--Bio-bibliography*** under names of places, names of individual Christian denominations or monastic and religious orders, literatures, including individual genres, ethnic groups, and topical headings, for works containing both biographical information about persons associated with the topic in question and bibliographies of writings by and/or about them. In general, the bibliography is primary and the biography is secondary.

LC practice: Assign a subject heading for a topic for works containing both biographical information about persons associated with the topic in question and bibliographies of writings by and/or about them. Also assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Bio-bibliographies***.

Example:

Title: The pro football bio-bibliography.

650 #0 $a Football $v Bio-bibliography.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Football.

655 #7 $a Bio-bibliographies. $2 lcgft

Do not use ***--Bio-bibliography*** under classes of persons, unless a heading for the corresponding subject area does not exist and cannot be established.

Use ***--Bio-bibliography*** only for works that cover more than one person, not for bio-bibliographies of a single individual. For the latter type of work, assign separate headings to cover the biographical and bibliographical aspects of the work

LC practice: Treat bio-bibliographies about individual persons and classes of persons the same as bio-bibliographies about any other topic. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Bio-bibliographies***.

Example:

Title: Spencer Tracy : a bio-bibliography.

600 10 $a Tracy, Spencer, $d 1900-1967.

600 10 $a Tracy, Spencer, $d 1900-1967 $v Bibliography.

650 #0 $a Motion picture actors and actresses $v Biography.

LC practice:

600 10 $a Tracy, Spencer, $d 1900-1967.

650 #0 $a Motion picture actors and actresses.

655 #7 $a Bio-bibliographies. $2 lcgft

E. Dictionaries

For bio-bibliographies arranged in dictionary format, use ***--Bio-bibliography--Dictionaries*** and subdivide further by language, if appropriate, in accordance with H 1540.

LC practice: For bio-bibliographies arranged in dictionary format, also assign LCGFT ***Dictionaries***. Bring out language through the appropriate aspects of descriptive cataloging.

Revision history

2026-02: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.